

Meoncross School History Department

**YEAR 7 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-
2027)**

Teacher Companion Guide

Curriculum Evaluation & Pedagogical Strengths

Strengths & Commendable Practices

Strong Local History Connections

Integrating local context into national and global events serves as a fantastic pedagogical hook. Mentions of the "Fareham ironmaster" in the Industrialisation unit and the profound impact of the "Lost Generation" on the "village of Stubbington" directly ground the history for our pupils. This makes the narrative tangible and relevant to their lived environment, fostering deeper engagement.

Thematic GCSE Preparation

The inclusion of *Water and Sanitation Through Time* acts as an excellent, low-stakes conceptual primer for the Edexcel GCSE *Medicine Through Time* thematic study. It introduces pupils to broad chronology (Roman to Industrial) and core concepts of change, continuity, and significance long before they hit the rigor of GCSE, ensuring a seamless transition.

Solid Chronological Foundation

By correctly sequencing the curriculum to transition from the broad sweep of *Water and Sanitation* directly into *Medieval England (1066-1485)*, pupils gain the vital contextual bedrock (feudalism, Church power, the monarchy) needed to understand the complex religious and power shifts of the Early Modern era.

De-centering the British Narrative

Starting with, or heavily featuring, the *History of Australia* and framing the Early Modern unit as *Global Encounters (1450-1750)* is a very modern, progressive approach. It intentionally moves away from the traditional, purely anglocentric Tudor/Stuart narrative to look critically at the mechanics of early empire, global trade, and the Transatlantic Slave Trade, creating a more diverse and inclusive curriculum.

Deep Dive on World War I

Splitting the Great War into two distinct units (Causes vs. The War) allows for rigorous historical debate (e.g., the Anglo-German naval race, alliance systems). This ensures

pupils aren't just learning the "mud and blood" narrative, but are actively grappling with complex geopolitical causation.

Points for Improvement for 2026/2027

1. Overweighting the 20th Century

Currently, there are two whole units dedicated to the Great War, plus units mapped out for the Second World War, the Shoah, the Cold War, and Post-War Britain. While vital, this risks creating a "modern-heavy" curriculum, sometimes at the expense of early world history.

2. Pre-1450 Global Diversity

The curriculum would benefit from a deep dive into non-European civilizations before European contact. Exploring the Islamic Golden Age, the Mali Empire, or the Silk Roads *before* looking at European "Global Encounters" in 1450 would give pupils a much more balanced view of global history, rather than encountering diverse cultures primarily through the lens of European colonization.

Evidence of Impact & Curriculum Mapping

1. Local Context & Coastal Connections

As a coastal school, our curriculum is intentionally designed to root global and national historical events in the maritime geography and lived environment of our pupils.

- **Oceanic Voyages & Penal Colonies:** The Year 8 Australia unit is deeply tied to maritime history, the brutality of ocean voyages, and the establishment of coastal settlements like Botany Bay.
- **Maritime Trade & Naval Dominance:** Our Early Modern World unit explicitly links global power to mastery of the oceans, naval exploration, and control of the Transatlantic Slave Trade.
- **The Anglo-German Naval Race:** The Year 8 Great War unit features a dedicated study on HMS *Dreadnought*, proving how a contest for control of the sea directly sparked global conflict.
- **Local Coastal Impact:** We explicitly study the "Fareham ironmaster" and the impact of the "Lost Generation" on the coastal village of Stubbington, bridging global events with local geography.

2. Historical Skills Progression

Our curriculum ensures rigorous, sequential development of disciplinary thinking from Year 7 through to Year 9, preparing pupils for GCSE demands.

- **Source Utility:** Moves from basic comprehension in Year 7 to evaluating provenance, motive, and audience (e.g., analyzing WWI propaganda and recruitment posters) in Year 8.
- **Historical Interpretations:** Progresses from identifying differing views to critically evaluating opposing academic debates (e.g., assessing modern vs. traditional interpretations of the Magna Carta or the 'Lions led by Donkeys' WWI debate) using contextual knowledge.

- **Argumentation (PEEL):** Pupils progress from supported, structured paragraphs to independent, multi-causal essays evaluating 'significance' and 'change over time'.
- **Causation:** Transitions from identifying simple triggers to categorizing long-term vs. short-term causes (e.g., the complex alliance systems and naval race of 1914).

3. Diversity, Equity & Representation

We are committed to delivering a curriculum that de-centers traditional anglocentric narratives, elevating the voices of the marginalized and giving pupils a truly global perspective.

- **Indigenous Perspectives:** The History of Australia unit critically examines the impact of British settlement on Indigenous peoples, moving beyond the traditional 'discovery' narrative.
- **Enslaved Voices:** The Early Modern World unit focuses on the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade and actively highlights how enslaved Africans resisted.
- **The 'Ordinary' Voice:** The Industrialisation unit explores how ordinary working-class people, rather than just monarchs, fought for a voice and the expansion of democracy.
- **The Forgotten Armies:** The Great War unit deliberately questions how much of a 'World' war it was by uncovering the forgotten contributions of the Empire's troops.
- **Experiential Learning (Ypres Trip):** The upcoming Year 9 Battlefields Trip to Ypres provides an invaluable opportunity for pupils to walk the ground of the Great War, cementing their classroom learning with powerful lived experience.

4. Pedagogical Strengths (SEND & Accessibility)

The integrated use of the Meoncross School History Department app alongside printed A4 workbooks and textbooks is deliberately designed to provide maximum support for SEND pupils:

- **Cognitive Offloading:** The combination of guided workbooks directly matched to structured digital tasks significantly reduces working memory strain, allowing pupils to focus entirely on historical thinking.
- **Dual Coding & Scaffolding:** The app utilizes consistent visual layouts, dual-coded images for vocabulary, and highly structured scaffolding (like sentence starters and PEEL frameworks) to support pupils with dyslexia or processing needs.
- **Multimodal Engagement:** By seamlessly transitioning between interactive digital tasks and focused reading from printed textbooks, the curriculum caters to diverse

learning profiles while preventing screen fatigue.

5. Substantive Concept Mapping

In line with modern KS3 history pedagogy, we actively track and weave substantive concepts ("big ideas" like Empire, Religion, and Power) across different periods. Rather than teaching these as isolated definitions, pupils build complex mental schemas by encountering them in varied contexts—from the power of the Medieval Church, through to the ideological clashes of the Cold War.

6. "Worldbuilding" & Cultural Literacy

Before pupils can effectively tackle abstract disciplinary concepts (such as causation or source utility), they require a rich "picture of the past". Our curriculum deliberately immerses pupils in the sensory and lived experiences of historical periods—such as daily life in a medieval village or the harsh realities of a WW1 trench—ensuring a secure cultural and chronological grounding prior to high-level analysis.

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time

Year 7 | Why did it take so long to clean up Britain?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 How much progress did the Romans make in public health?	- Describe the key features of Roman public health infrastructure, including aqueducts, bathhouses, and sewers - Explain how the Roman Empire's centralised power enabled large-scale public health projects - Evaluate the significance of Roman public health by assessing whether it represented genuine medical understanding or imperial prestige	- Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Change & Continuity): How much progress did the Romans make in public health? - Evaluating Primary Evidence
Lesson 2 Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?	- Explain how the collapse of Roman imperial power led to the decline of organised public health systems - Describe the role of the medieval Church in shaping attitudes to disease and sanitation - Assess the significance of the Black Death (1348) as a turning point in medieval public health	Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Causation): Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?	• Describe the public health challenges caused by rapid urbanisation in Early Modern towns • Explain why governments failed to act despite growing evidence of poor sanitation • Evaluate the extent to which continuity, rather than change, defined public health between 1500 and 1750	• Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Significance): To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?
Lesson 4 How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?	• Explain how industrialisation and mass migration to cities created unprecedented public health crises • Describe the role of key individuals (John Snow, Edwin Chadwick) in challenging existing beliefs about disease • Analyse the significance of the 1848 Public Health Act as an example of government intervention driven by causation evidence	• Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Causation): How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 5 Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets?	- Explain why it took Parliament so long to act on public health reform despite mounting evidence - Describe how the 'Great Stink' of 1858 became a turning point that forced government action - Evaluate the significance of Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system as a landmark of change in public health	Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Significance): Evaluate the impact of Joseph Bazalgette's sewer system on London.
Lesson 6 End of Unit Assessment: Cholera Investigation	- Evaluate how Dr John Snow used map data and scientific deduction to prove cholera was waterborne in 1854. - Explain the shift from laissez-faire government attitudes to compulsory state intervention in British public health. - Produce a structured 8-mark explanation assessing the significance of Victorian sanitation reforms.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Key Vocabulary: Cholera, Miasma Theory, Laissez-Faire, Cesspit, Back-to-back housing, Public Health Act 1848, Public Health Act 1875, Broad Street Pump, The Great Stink, Sewage System, Edwin Chadwick, John Snow, Joseph Bazalgette, Industrial Revolution

KS3: Medieval England & The Struggle for Power (1066–1485)

Year 7 | How did power shift in Medieval England?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?	• Describe the three rival claims to the English throne in 1066 and assess which was strongest • Explain how the Battle of Hastings demonstrated the role of power, luck, and military strategy in shaping history • Evaluate the significance of the Norman Conquest as a turning point in English history	• Knowledge Recall Quiz • PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): The Claimants' Pitch (Group Battle) • PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): The Turning Point Debate (Evaluation) • Evaluating Primary Evidence

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 2 Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?	• Explain how William used castles, the feudal system, and terror as tools of power and control • Describe how the Domesday Book functioned as a mechanism of royal authority and resistance suppression • Assess the effectiveness of William's methods in crushing Anglo-Saxon resistance	• Comprehension Activity • PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Explain why William carried out the Harrying of the North and what the consequences were for the people living in the region. • PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Review the timeline of William's consolidation of power. Which method (Castles, Terror, or the Domesday Book) do you think was the most effective i... • Interrogating Historical Sources • Structured Paragraph
Lesson 3 Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?	• Explain why the relationship between the monarchy and the Church was a fundamental struggle for power in medieval England • Describe how the murder of Thomas Becket (1170) demonstrated the tension between feudal loyalty and religious authority • Evaluate the significance of the Becket affair for the balance of power between Church and Crown	• Core Knowledge Check • PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Explain the main reasons why the relationship between King Henry II and Archbishop Thomas Becket broke down completely between 1162 and 1164. • Creative Task: Eyewitness Report. Look closely at the manuscript illumination of Becket's murder. Imagine you are a terrified monk hiding behind the pillars of Ca... • Exam Practice Writing

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 4 Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?	- Describe the key grievances that led the barons to challenge King John's power - Explain the significance of Magna Carta as a challenge to absolute monarchy and a step towards parliamentary democracy - Evaluate contrasting historical interpretations of Magna Carta: triumph of liberty or selfish baronial power grab?	- Recall Quiz (5 questions) - Historical Interpretations: Historical Interpretations: The Magna Carta - PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): The Trial of King John (Interpretation)
Lesson 5 Lesson 5: Doom Paintings and Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?	- Describe the key features of daily life for the peasantry in a medieval village - Explain how the feudal system and the Church controlled virtually every aspect of a peasant's existence - Assess the extent to which medieval peasants had any real power or agency within the feudal hierarchy	- Knowledge Recall Quiz - PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Describe what a tithe was, how it was collected, and why it caused tension between ordinary medieval peasants and the Church. - Creative Task: Design your own modern Doom Painting. Medieval Doom Paintings used demons and hellfire to scare peasants into behaving. If you were painting a 'Doo... - Evaluating Primary Evidence - Extended Writing (PEEL)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 6 Lesson 6: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?	- Describe the causes and spread of the Black Death across medieval England - Explain how the plague shattered the feudal system by empowering the peasantry through labour shortages - Evaluate the significance of the Black Death as a catalyst for change in medieval social order	- Comprehension Activity - PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Explain how the Black Death transformed the balance of economic power between lords and peasants after 1348. - PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): The Plague Doctor's Diary (Empathetic Writing)
Lesson 7 Lesson 7: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?	- Explain the causes of the Peasants' Revolt, linking them to the decline of feudalism and growing resistance to royal power - Describe the key events of the revolt and the role of leaders like Wat Tyler - Evaluate whether the Peasants' Revolt was a failure or a significant step towards challenging the power of the monarchy and Parliament	- Core Knowledge Check - Creative Task: Speechwriting. You are the radical priest John Ball. Write a short, rousing speech to deliver to the peasant army before they march on London. Make... - PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): How much of a threat did the rebels actually pose to King Richard II and royal government when they seized London in June 1381?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 8 Lesson 8: The Wars of the Roses (1455–1485) - How did the medieval era end in blood?	• Describe the causes of the Wars of the Roses and how rival claims to the monarchy led to civil war • Explain how propaganda and political manipulation shaped the conflict between York and Lancaster • Evaluate the significance of Henry VII's victory at Bosworth as the end of the medieval era and the birth of Tudor power	• Recall Quiz (6 questions)
Lesson 9 Lesson 9: Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?	• Synthesise knowledge of power, monarchy, feudalism, and the Church across the medieval period • Construct a sustained argument evaluating how far a medieval monarch's power was limited by resistance from barons, the Church, and the peasantry • Deploy specific historical evidence to support a judgement about the nature of medieval power	• PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Which of the two interpretations do you find more convincing? Explain your answer using your own knowledge. • PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Explain why royal power weakened between 1066 and 1485 (12 marks) • Extended Writing (PEEL)

Key Vocabulary: Power, Claim, Conquest, Anglo-Saxon, Significance, Feudal system, Resistance, Propaganda, Domesday Book, Motte-and-bailey, Church, Monarchy, Martyr, Excommunication, Canon law, Magna Carta, Democracy, Parliament, Interpretation, Baron, Peasantry, Tithe, Feudalism, Serf, Strip farming, Black Death, Change, Labour shortage, Statute of Labourers, Social order, Revolt, Poll tax, Wat Tyler, Villeinage, Dynasty, Usurper, Synthesis, Evidence, Judgement